VENICE, 1494

The "Einstein" quote has no source. The real trick is 530 years old.

> Swipe for the math that works.

Did Einstein say it? No evidence.

~~“Compound interest is the most powerful force in the universe. — Einstein”~~

> Quote Investigator found no evidence he said it.

The trail runs through ads and letters.

1916 Newspaper ad

1976 WSJ letter

Today Everywhere

"The greatest invention the world has ever produced."

> An ad for an investment company, spoken by a character a copywriter made up.

His Summa (Venice, 1494) has the Rule of 72.

1494

Summa de arithmetica, Venice

72 ÷ rate ≈ years to double.

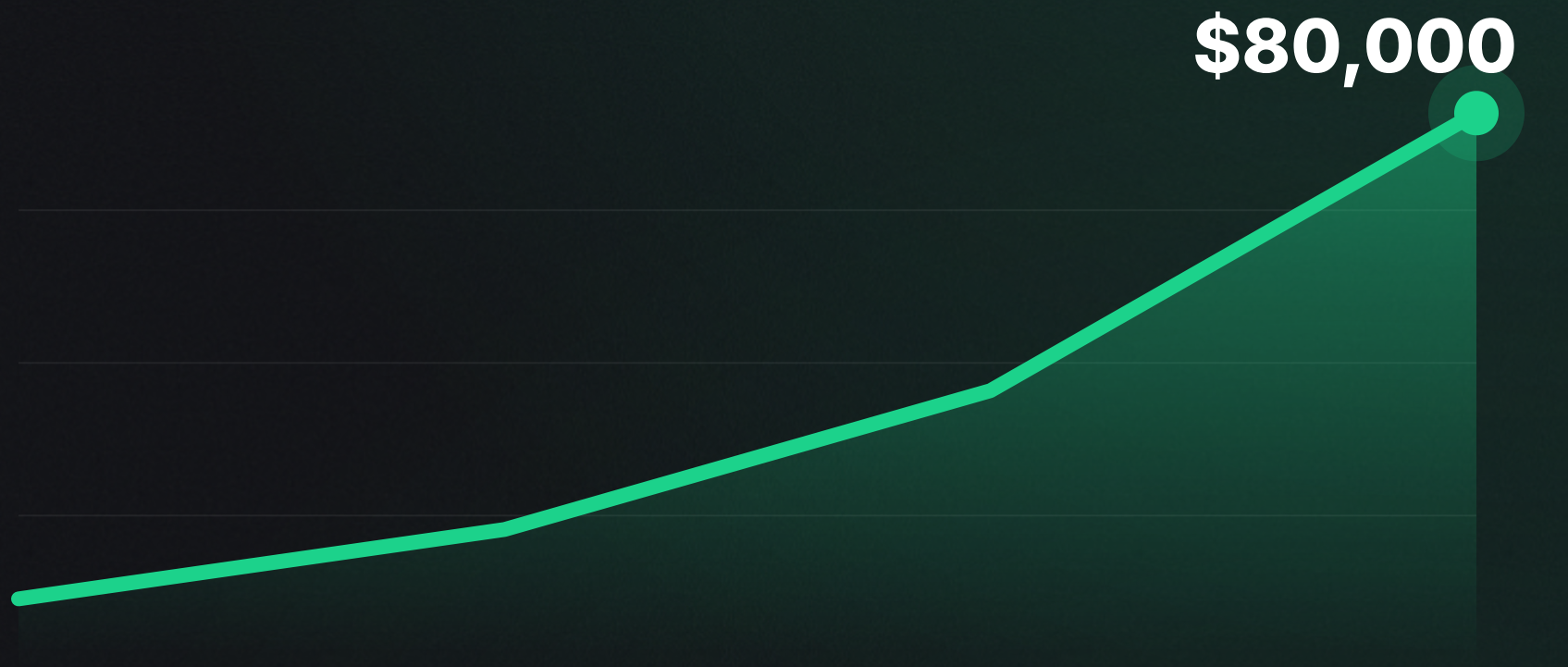

Illustration: $10,000 at 6% a year doubles about every 12 years (72 ÷ 6).

At 24%, an unpaid balance doubles in about 3 years.

SAVINGS AT 6%

≈ 12 years to double

DEBT AT 24%

≈ 3 years to double

Don't sleep until debits = credits.

> The Summa also holds one of the first published descriptions of double-entry bookkeeping.

Put your numbers next to 72.

1. 72 ÷ savings return
2. 72 ÷ loan rate
3. 72 ÷ fund fee

> Five minutes. Share it with your team.